

Android Lollipop: What's in it for Enterprises?

Enterprise mobility offers a wealth lot of opportunities for OEMs, solutions providers, UX designers, and developers. On the face of it, this may appear as easy as mobile applications grabbing business data from enterprise servers, but the reality is completely different. Read on to learn more.



Let's start this discussion by defining what enterprise mobility actually is. In my opinion, it is the trend that denotes the shift in how today's employees think about working from out of the office. It's about their current expectations regarding accessing enterprise business flows from their mobile devices in a seamless manner.

From the perspective of an enterprise's CIO (Chief Information Officer) or CISO (Chief Information Security Officer), enterprise mobility is an immensely investment hungry trend, because it requires mobile access to enterprise data and sometimes business-critical enterprise data over non-trusted networks—all from an employee's mobile device.

The 'bring your own device' (BYOD) practice at work is now inevitable for any enterprise interested in enterprise

mobility. Various enterprise mobility management (EMM) solutions are available in the market, which are capable of addressing an organisation's data security and device management needs.

Android's Lollipop OS is quite different from its predecessors in terms of enterprise capabilities. One of the core requirements for supporting BYOD is the identification of enterprise applications and personal applications on the users' devices. So far, established EMM providers have been addressing this challenge in customised ways. Hence, the capabilities they offer vary from one product to another. However Lollipop is coming out with a new set of APIs called 'Android for Work', built over Samsung's Knox security framework. Currently, all popular OEMs are working with Google to provide support for 'Android for Work' on their devices.